

What factors influence the time I spend on my job search?

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Initial Guiding Question:

How is the time I spend on average in a day applying to jobs or researching potential jobs affected by how much time in a day I spend on other engagements?

Figure 1

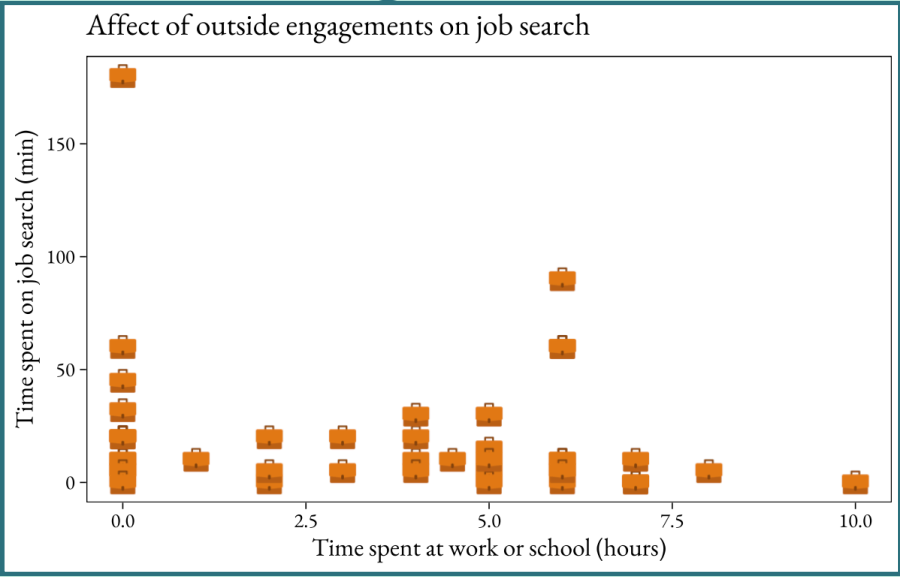
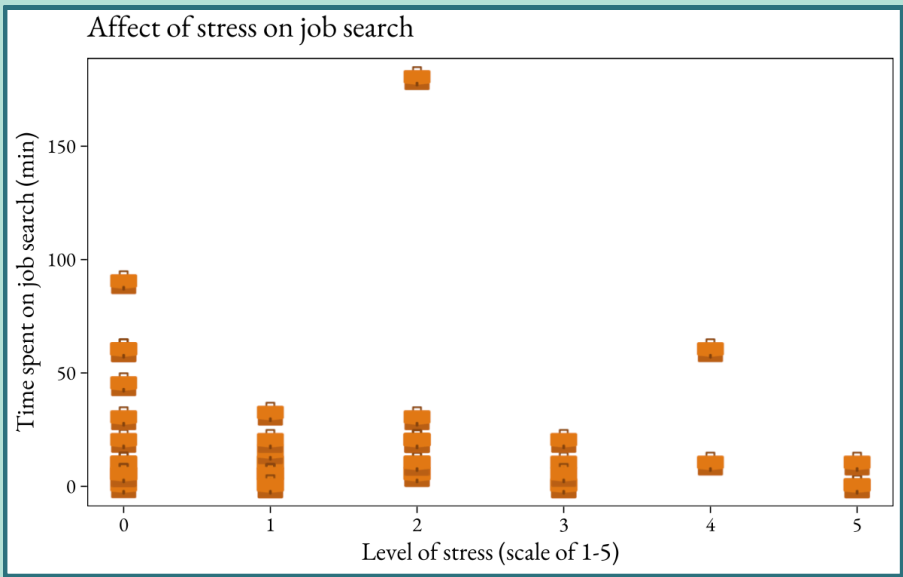


Figure 2



Stress as a new variable of interest:

As I continued to collect data, I observed that I felt far less motivated to search for and apply to jobs when I felt stressed about other responsibilities. The scatterplot I created appeared less varied than my initial plot.

Ridgeline graph for stress:

After creating the scatterplot, I wanted to explore the stress variable further. From this plot, it became more apparent that when I had no stress, the time spent on my job search did increase. However, even when I had the smallest level of stress, my job search appeared to drastically decrease.

Figure 3

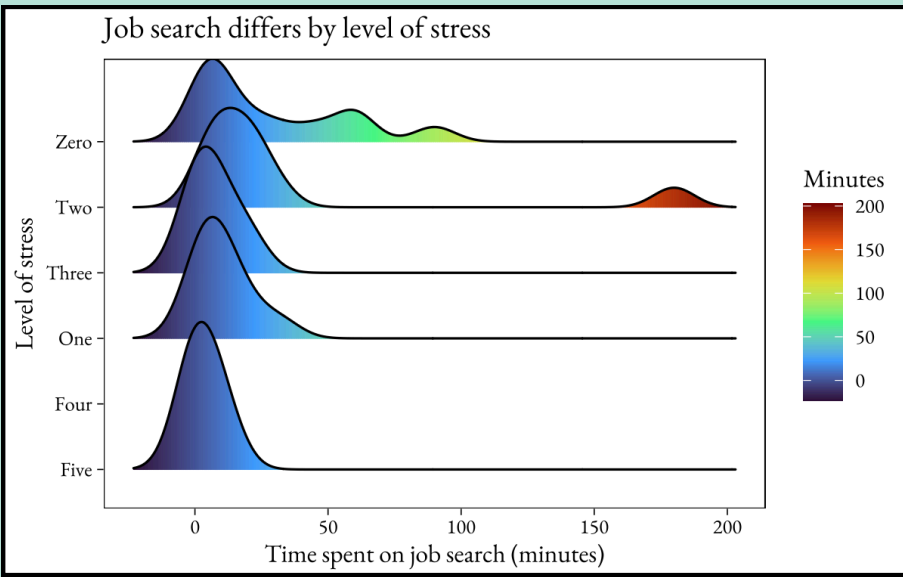
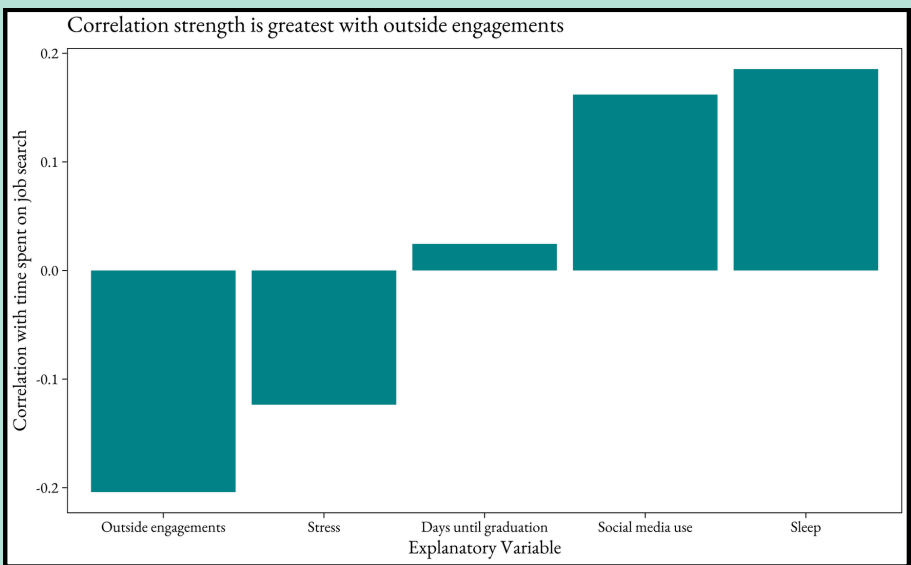


Figure 4



Correlation for all variables:

To check if my intuition was accurate about stress having a greater effect than outside engagements, I wanted to compare correlations between all my explanatory variables. Contrary to what I thought, outside engagements ended up having the strongest negative correlation, but stress only had the fourth strongest correlation.

About Data:

This personal research project began on April 24th, 2026, and that is when I first began recording the six explanatory variables and the one response variable, which is the time spent on my job search. As of June 4th, 2026 the dataset consists of 41 observations for all of the variables.